



ROUTEUP CAREER GUIDANCE SERIES — VOLUME 10

The Parents' Guide

How to Support Your Child's Dream — Safely and Wisely

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A Word With the Real Decision-Makers

Respected parents — this volume is written for you. Your savings fund this journey, your signature secures the loan, and your peace of mind travels with your child. You deserve plain answers, not English jargon and agent promises. This guide gives you the questions to ask and the warning signs to watch, so the family decides together, with open eyes.

Myth: “The agent said everything is guaranteed — job, visa, PR.”

Reality: No private person can guarantee what governments and employers decide. An honest adviser explains chances and risks; a salesman guarantees outcomes. The word 'guarantee' in this industry is where most family losses begin.

Myth: “Everyone's children are going — ours should too.”

Reality: Some children thrive abroad; some courses lead nowhere; some families take loans that shadow them for fifteen years. The neighbours' decision was made for the neighbours' child, finances, and goals — not yours. Comparison is how good families make bad decisions.

Myth: “Once the visa comes, the difficult part is over.”

Reality: The visa is the beginning. The first year abroad — housing, budgeting, job hunting, loneliness — is the hard part. Your role changes after departure: from funding the dream to steadying the person living it.

The Money Conversation — Have It Before Anything Else

- Ask the bank for the TOTAL repayment figure in writing, not the loan amount. A ₹40 lakh loan over 15 years can approach ₹1 crore. Decide as a family whether the expected career justifies that number.
- Never borrow briefly to 'show' money for the visa — it is fraud, it is often detected, and it can bar your child from that country for years.
- Budget for the full course duration plus a 20–30% buffer, assuming ZERO part-time income. If the plan only works when your child finds work immediately, the plan is not ready.
- Keep an emergency fund in India untouched by the project. Families who commit everything have no options when anything changes.

Six Questions to Ask Any Consultancy — In Any Language

- “Does this university or college pay you a commission for our enrolment?” (Honest ones answer.)
- “Show us this course's graduate employment numbers — from the university, not your brochure.”
- “What is written in your contract about refunds if the visa is refused?”
- “Why this country for OUR child, and not the two cheapest alternatives?”
- “Which official government website can we verify all this on?”
- “Will you put every promise you just made in writing, with your signature?”

A consultancy that resists these questions has answered them.

Protecting Your Child From a Distance

- Agree a fixed weekly call before departure — same day, same time. It protects their mental health and your peace, and makes silence itself an early warning.
- Know these details yourself: university name, course, city, address, the international student office contact, and the local emergency number.

- Tell your child explicitly: “If money runs short, tell us first — never borrow from strangers or 'community helpers' abroad.” Exploitation of isolated students is real, and it begins where family communication ends.
- If anyone contacts YOU demanding urgent fees — 'your child will be deported unless you pay today' — it is almost always a scam. Verify with your child and the university directly before sending anything.

What consultancies won't tell you: they market to students, but they fear informed parents — because parents ask about money, contracts, and accountability. Your questions are not interference. They are the quality control this industry lacks.

Worksheet — The Family Decision

- ☐ We know the TOTAL cost (tuition + living + buffer) and the TOTAL loan repayment, in writing
- ☐ The plan survives 12 months with no part-time income
- ☐ We asked the six consultancy questions and received straight answers
- ☐ We verified the course and visa rules on the official government website ourselves
- ☐ Weekly call time is fixed; we hold the key contacts and document copies
- ☐ Our child chose this course for a career reason they can explain to us in two minutes

When to Get Help

Everything in this volume you can act on yourself — that is deliberate. But the worksheet you just filled has answers only YOU could write, and validating those answers against real requirements, real budgets, and real immigration rules is where mistakes hide.

Bring your completed family decision checklist session with RouteUp. We will go through it line by line and tell you honestly — including if your plan is fine and you don't need us further.

Book your free session: www.routeup.co.in · hello@routeup.co.in ·

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